

THE IPSOS NEW ZEALAND ISSUES MONITOR

An Ipsos Survey – September 2020

GAME CHANGERS



THE IPSOS NEW ZEALAND ISSUES MONITOR OVERVIEW

Background Information

At Ipsos, we are passionately curious about people, markets, brands and society. We make our changing world easier and faster to navigate and inspire clients to make smarter decisions. As Ipsos and our previous brands we have operated in New Zealand since 1992.

The Ipsos New Zealand Issues Monitor tracks what New Zealanders are concerned about, who is worried about what, and which political parties are seen to be best able to improve these matters. From 11th to 14th September September we conducted fieldwork for our eleventh Ipsos NZ Issues Monitor report with a total of 1,000 New Zealanders aged 18 and older*.

The first Issues Monitor wave in 2020 was conducted at the beginning of March when only a few COVID-19 cases had reached NZ. However, due to the COVID-19 pandemic a second wave was conducted relatively quickly in May, the third wave in July and the current wave in September to understand what issues were important to New Zealanders under the current alert Level 2 / 2.5.

This study did not have any external sponsors or partners. It was initiated and run by Ipsos because we are curious about the world we live in and how citizens around the globe think and feel about their world.

Please direct all queries to Carin Hercock – phone: 09 538 0500 or email: carin.hercock@ipsos.com or Amanda

Dudding – phone: 021 61 22 64 or email: amanda.dudding@ipsos.com



THE IPSOS NEW ZEALAND ISSUES MONITOR OVERVIEW

The Media Context: What was making New Zealand news in early September 2020?

NEW ZEALAND / COVID-19

Covid-19: Auckland to remain at alert level 2.5 until at least 16 September - Ardern

RNZ – 4 September 2020

NEW ZEALAND

Covid 19 coronavirus: Man in his 50s dies in Auckland, first virus death in three months

NZ Herald - 4 September 2020

NEW ZEALAND ●

Jacinda Ardern wants to make Matariki a public holiday from 2022

Newshub – 7 September 2020

POLITICS / ELECTION 2020

National promises \$1.9bn for education in learning support, teacher aides, character schools

RNZ– 14 September 2020

NEW ZEALAND

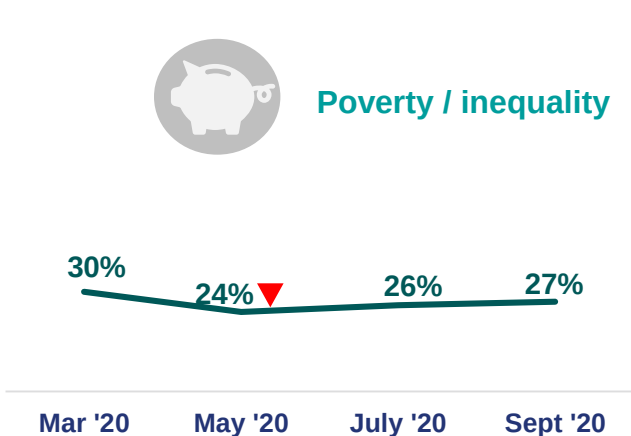
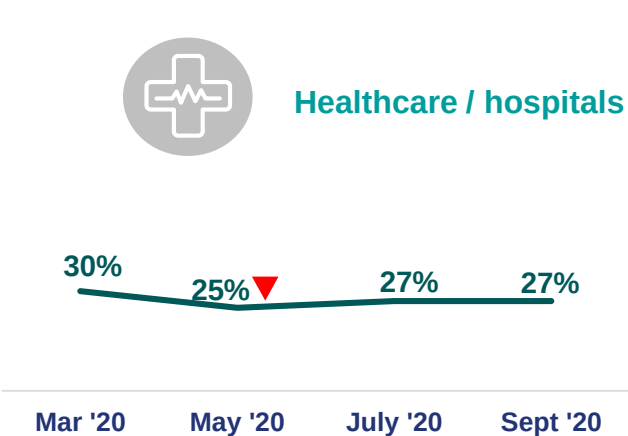
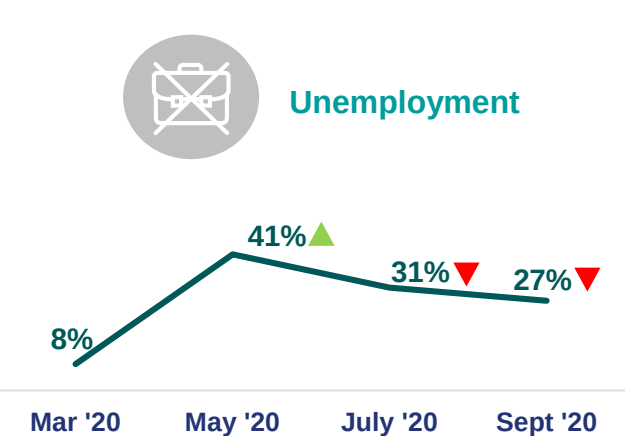
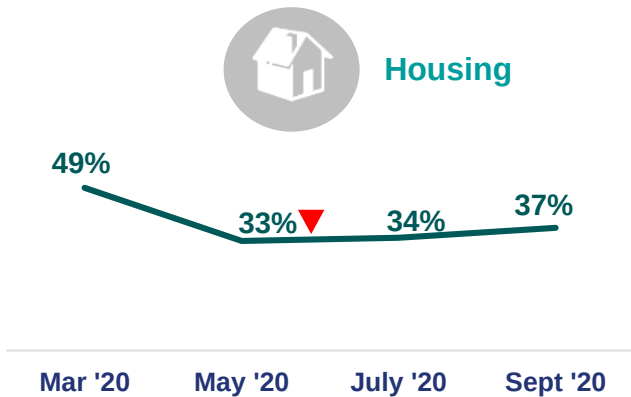
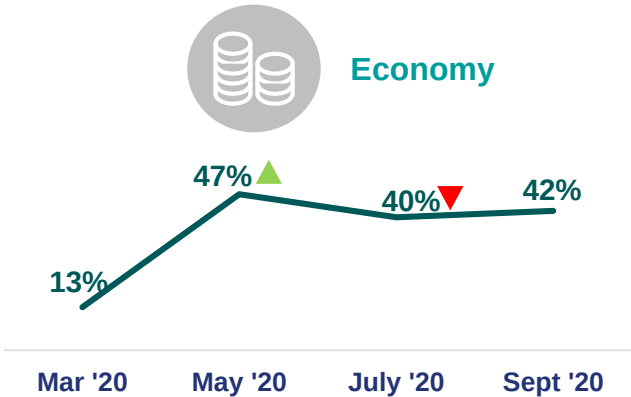
Covid 19 coronavirus: Six new community cases all linked to Mt Roskill 'mini cluster'

NZ Herald – 9 September 2020

KEY FINDINGS – SEPTEMBER 2020

Top issues

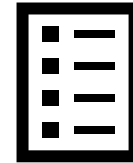
Following the second wave of COVID-19 in August, *Economy* remains the main concern facing New Zealanders. This is followed by *housing* which had been the most dominant issue prior to COVID-19. Concerns around *unemployment* are decreasing, although are still much higher than pre-pandemic levels. *Healthcare* and *Poverty* remain in the top 5 key issues faced by New Zealanders.



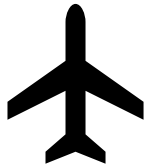
KEY FINDINGS – SEPTEMBER 2020



The **performance of the current Labour-led coalition government** remains high. The Labour party is also perceived to be the **most capable** of managing the majority of issues facing New Zealanders



87% of New Zealanders are **comfortable voting in an election**.
Comfort levels have continued to increase since March–April '20 (level 4 lockdown)



72% of New Zealanders believe that **we should keep our borders closed**. However, this opinion has softened since March / April, when New Zealand was in level 4 lockdown



77% of New Zealanders agree that they would **get a COVID-19 vaccine** should it become available

THE TOP ISSUES

The most important issues facing
New Zealand today

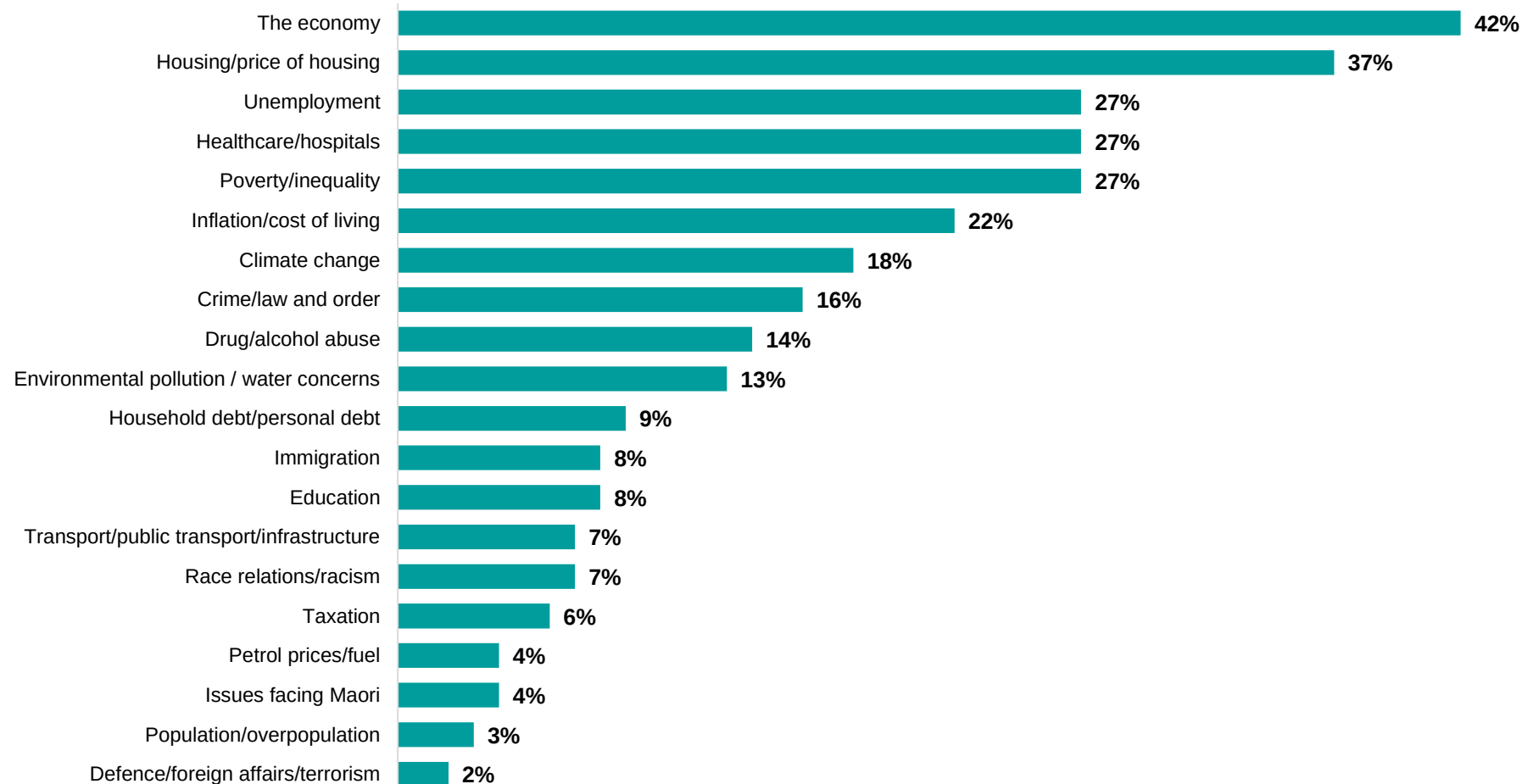
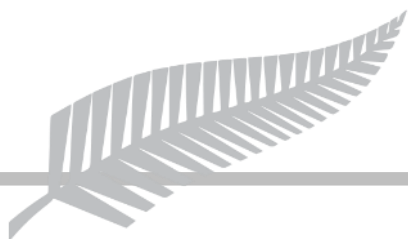
THE MOST IMPORTANT ISSUES FACING NEW ZEALAND

(September '20)



The Economy (42%) maintains its spot as the top issue facing New Zealand today.

The price of housing (37%) is the second most important issue, followed by unemployment, healthcare / hospitals, and poverty / inequality at 27%.



Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

Base: September '20 (n=1,000)

TOP FIVE ISSUES OVER TIME

The top 5 issues remain consistent with those observed in July. Although there has been a decrease in concern surrounding unemployment, it remains the third most prominent issue.

	APR 19 (n=615)		NOV 19 (n=615)		MARCH 20 (n=610)		MAY 20 (n=1,000)		JULY 20 (n=1,000)		SEPT 20 (n=1,000)	
1	Housing / Price of Housing	41%	Housing / Price of Housing	42%	Housing / Price of Housing	49%	The Economy	47%	The Economy	40%	The Economy	42%
2	Poverty / Inequality	30%	Poverty / Inequality	29%	Healthcare / Hospitals	30%	Unemployment	41%	Housing / Price of Housing	34%	Housing / Price of Housing	37%
3	Inflation / Cost of Living	28%	Inflation / Cost of Living	25%	Poverty / Inequality	30%	Housing / Price of Housing	33%	Unemployment	31%	Unemployment	27%
4	Healthcare / Hospitals	25%	Healthcare / Hospitals	25%	Inflation / Cost of Living	25%	Healthcare / Hospitals	25%	Healthcare / Hospitals	27%	Healthcare / Hospitals	27%
5	Crime / Law	25%	Crime / Law	23%	Crime / Law	25%	Poverty / Inequality	24%	Poverty / Inequality	26%	Poverty / Inequality	27%
	Following Christchurch terror attacks				Only a few COVID-19 cases in NZ		NZ moves out of level 4 lockdown		Alert Level 1		Alert Level 2 (second wave of cases)	

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

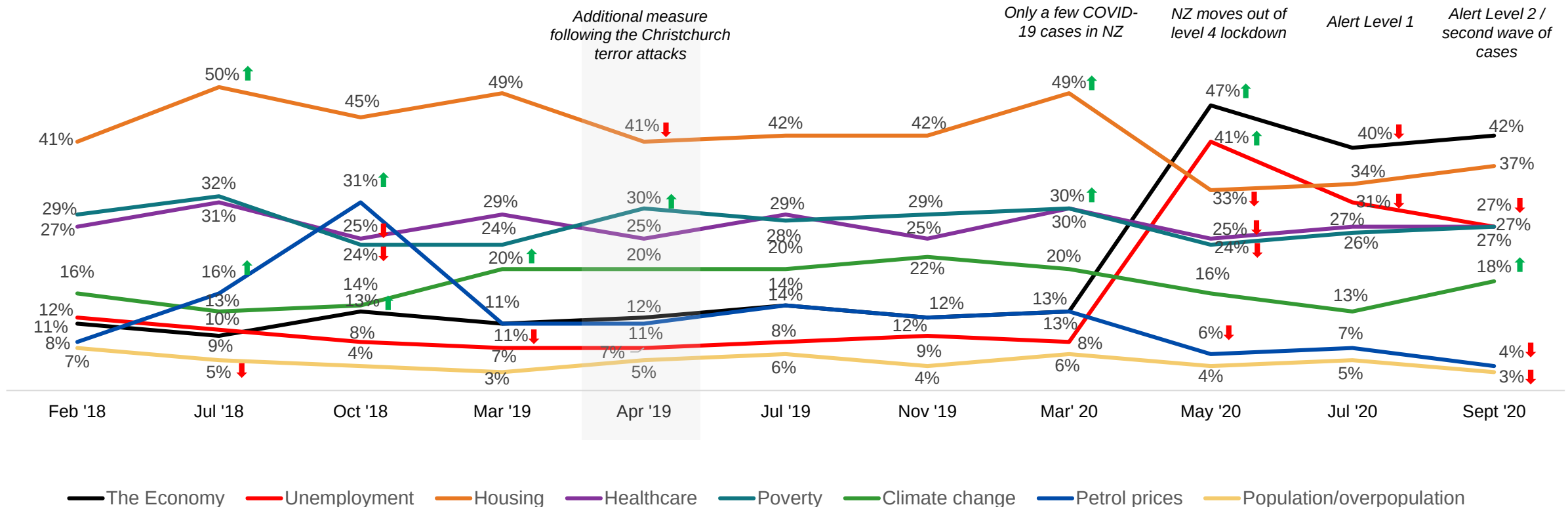
Base: Sept '20 (n=1,000), July '20 (n=1,000), May '20 (n=1,000), Mar '20 (n=610), Nov '19 (n=610), Apr '19 (n=615)

8 – © Ipsos | NZ Issues Monitor

↑ ↓ Indicates significant increase / decrease in score compared to the previous wave

NOTEWORTHY ISSUES

As the pandemic continues, economy and unemployment continue to concern New Zealanders along with other prominent issues like housing, healthcare, and poverty. Concern about climate change has picked up this wave after a drop during the COVID-19.



Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

Base: Sept '20 (n=1,000), July '20 (n=1,000), May '20 (n=1,000), Mar '20 (n=610), Nov '19 (n=610), Jul '19 (n=610), Apr '19 (n=615), Mar '19 (n=614), Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)

CURRENT GOVERNMENT PERFORMANCE

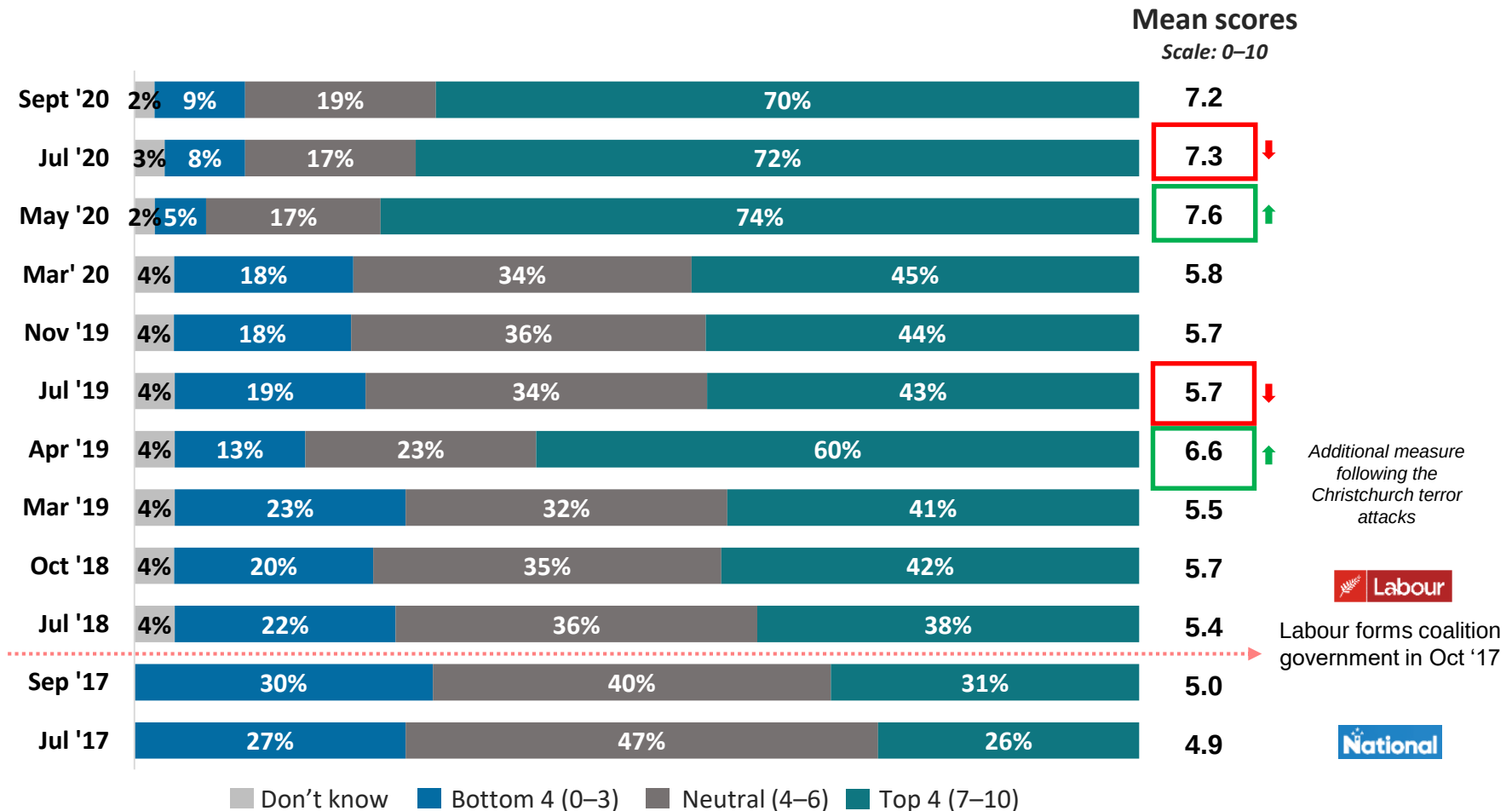
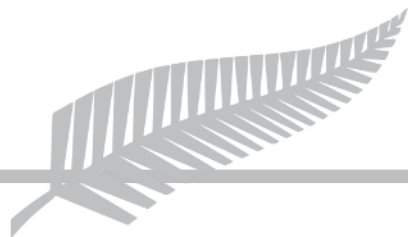
RATING OF GOVERNMENT OVER LAST 6 MONTHS

Perceptions of the current Labour-led coalition government's performance remain high.

Following a period of stable results from July '19 to March '20, the Labour-led coalition's performance significantly increased to a mean score rating of 7.6 out of 10 in May 2020 during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Perceptions remain high (7.2) despite a decline in July '20.

70% of all respondents gave the coalition government a rating of between 7–10 out of 10.



Q: Overall, how would you rate the government for its job in the last 6 months from 0 to 10, where 0 means 'abysmal' and 10 means 'outstanding'?

Base: Sept '20 (n=1,000), Jul '20 (n=1000), May '20 (n=1,000), Mar '20 (n=610), Nov '19 (n=610), Jul '19 (n=610), Apr '19 (n=615), Mar '19 (n=614), Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)

MANAGING THE ISSUES

The political parties perceived as most capable of managing the issues

POLITICAL PARTY MOST CAPABLE OF MANAGING ISSUES

Consistent with previous waves, the Labour Party is seen as the political party most capable of managing the majority of issues. Climate change and environment-related issues are perceived as best-handled by the Green Party.

ISSUE	POLITICAL PARTY
1: The Economy	 Labour
2: Housing/Price of Housing	 Labour
3=: Poverty/Inequality	 Labour
3=: Healthcare/Hospitals	 Labour
3=: Unemployment	 Labour
6: Inflation/Cost of Living	 Labour
7: Climate Change	 Green
8=: Crime/Law and Order	 Labour
9: Drug / Alcohol Abuse	 Labour
10: Environmental Pollution/Water Concerns	 Green

ISSUE	POLITICAL PARTY
11: Household Debt/Personal Debt	 Labour
12=: Immigration	 Labour
12=: Education	 Labour
14=: Race Relations/Racism	 Labour
14=: Transport/Public Transport/Infrastructure	 Labour
16: Taxation	 Labour
17=: Issues facing Māori	 Labour
17=: Petrol Prices/Fuel	 Labour
19: Population/Overpopulation	 Labour
20: Defence/Foreign Affairs	 Labour

Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues:
Base: September '20 (n=1,000)

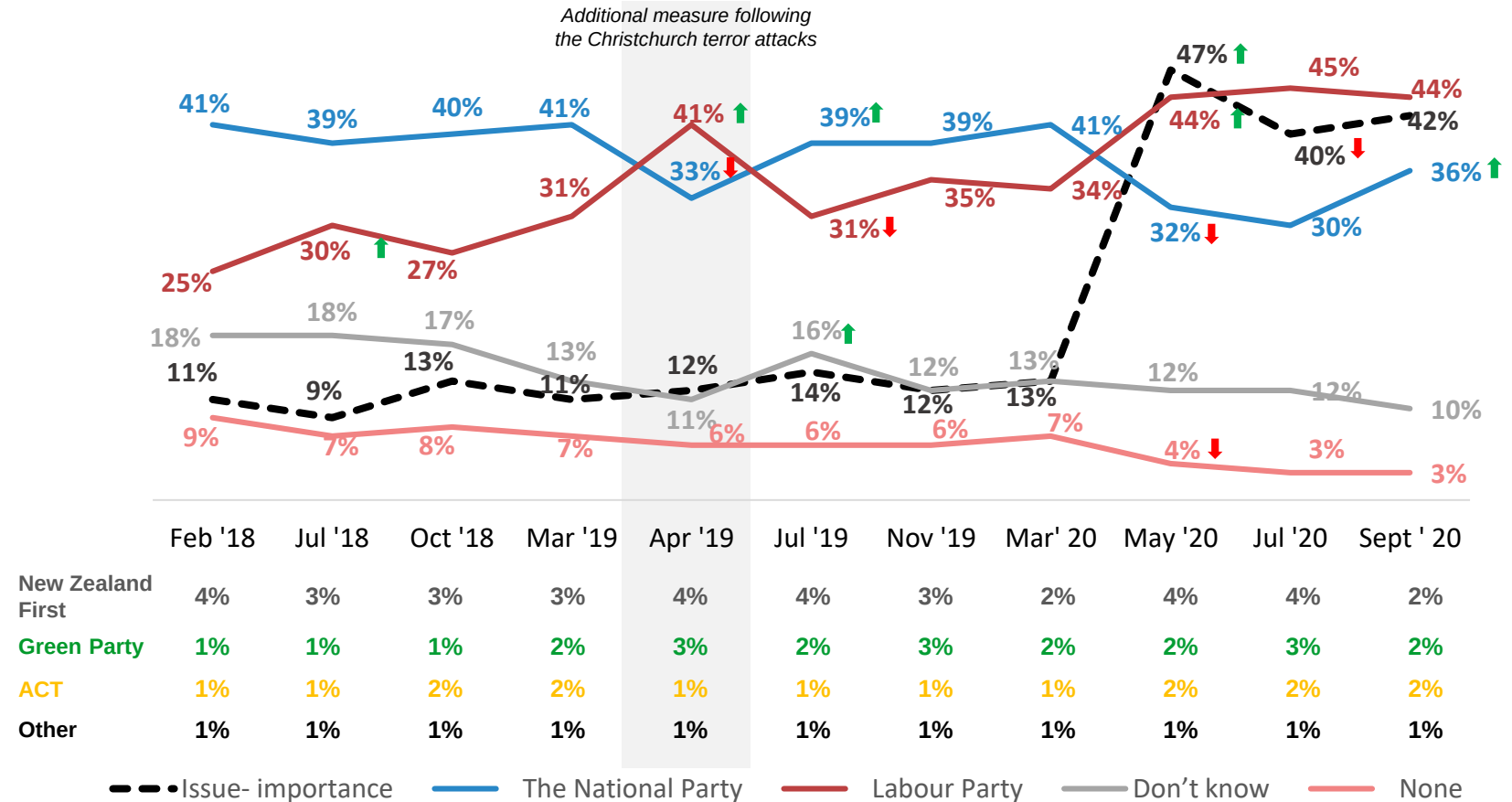
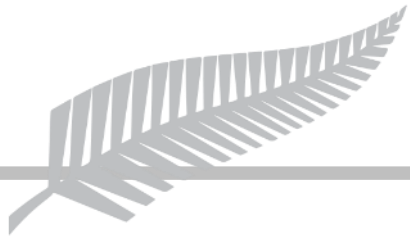
#1 ISSUE – THE ECONOMY

The perception of the National Party's capability of managing the economy has increased after a significant decrease in May, this is still below the Labour Party.



The Labour Party is seen as the political party most capable of managing the number 1 issue of the economy.

Historically, National party had an upper hand. However, the importance of this issue surged due to the COVID-19 pandemic and perceptions of The Labour Party's ability to manage this #1 issue also increased significantly at that time.



Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: The Economy
 Base: Approx. n=610 per wave, except for May '20, Jul '20, Sept '20 (n=1,000)

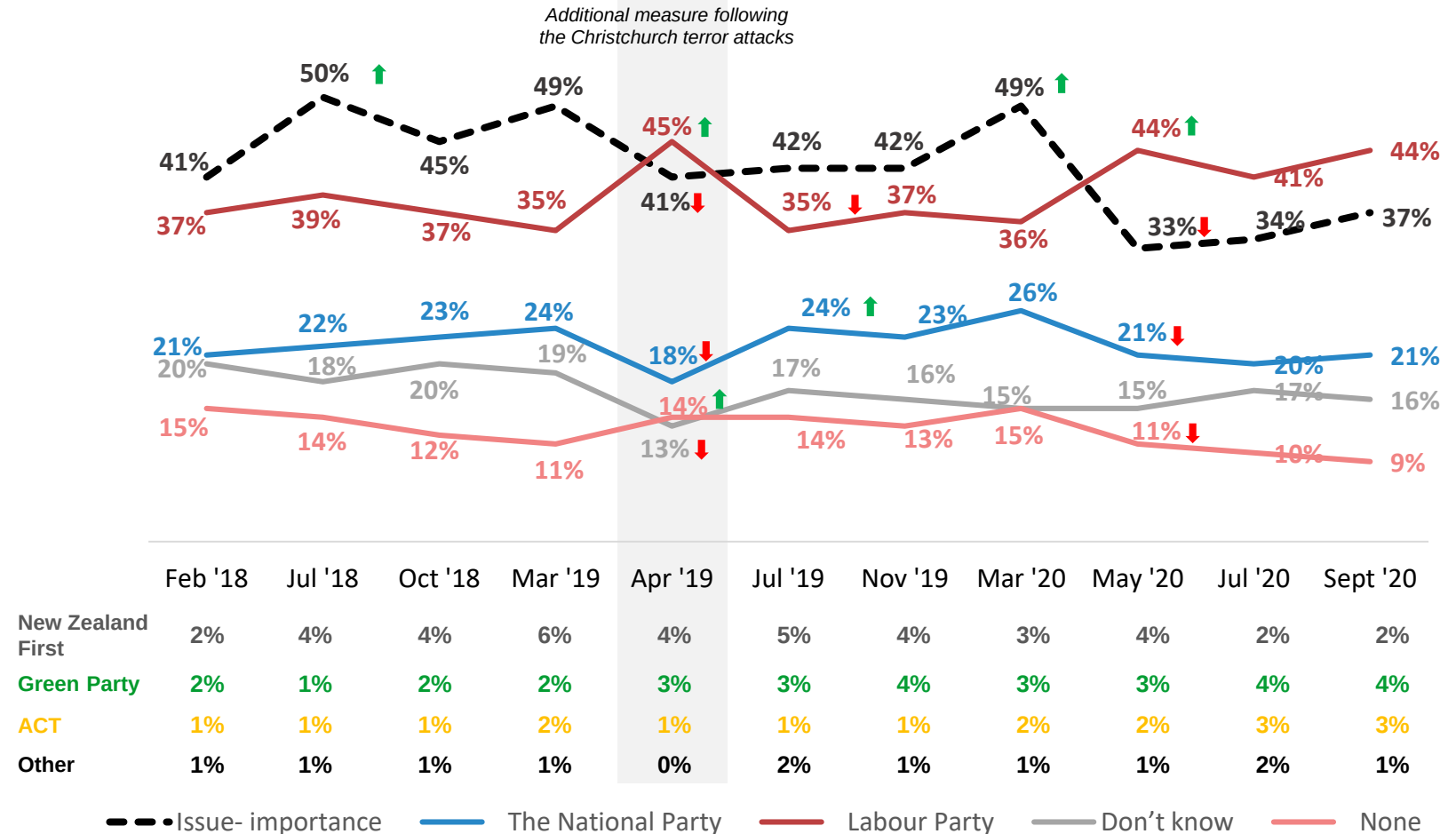
#2 ISSUE – HOUSING / PRICE OF HOUSING

The Labour Party remains significantly ahead of other parties in perceived ability to manage housing / price of housing.



Housing remains one of the top three issues despite a significant drop in May due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

The Labour Party is perceived by New Zealanders as being the party most capable of managing housing / the price of housing, currently sitting 23 percentage points higher than the National Party.



Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Housing / Price of Housing
 Base: Approx. n=610 per wave, except for May '20, Jul '20, Sept '20 (n=1,000)

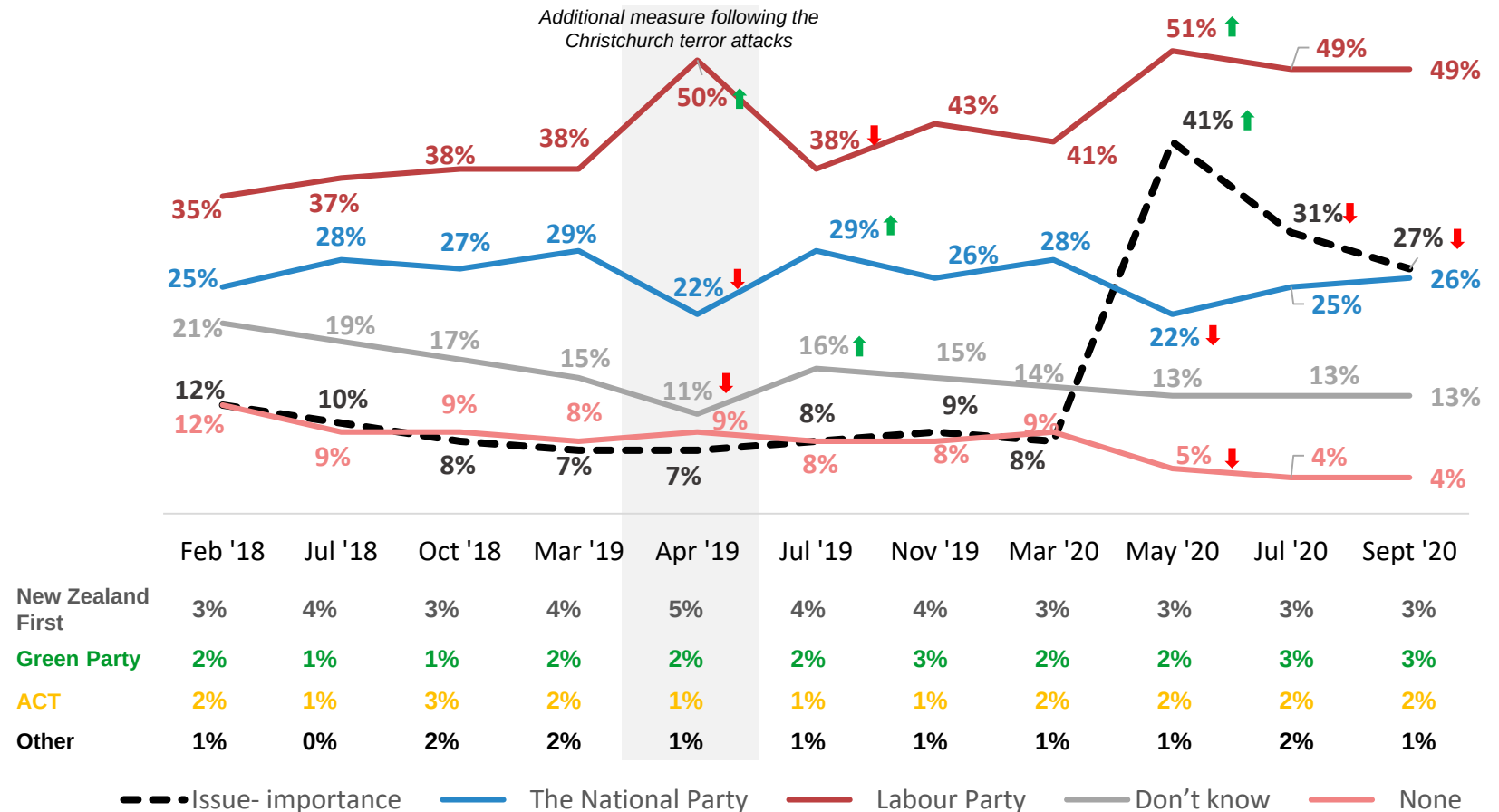
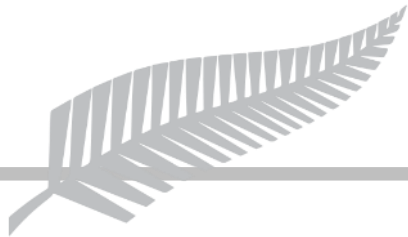
#3= ISSUE – UNEMPLOYMENT

The Labour Party maintains their position as the party seen as best to deal with unemployment.



Prior to the COVID-19 pandemic unemployment wasn't seen as a major concern. However, concerns around unemployment increased significantly in May '20.

Despite a drop in July and Sept '20, concerns surrounding unemployment remain much higher compared to the pre-COVID-19 period.



Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Unemployment
 Base: Approx. n=610 per wave, except for May '20, Jul '20, Sept '20 (n=1,000)

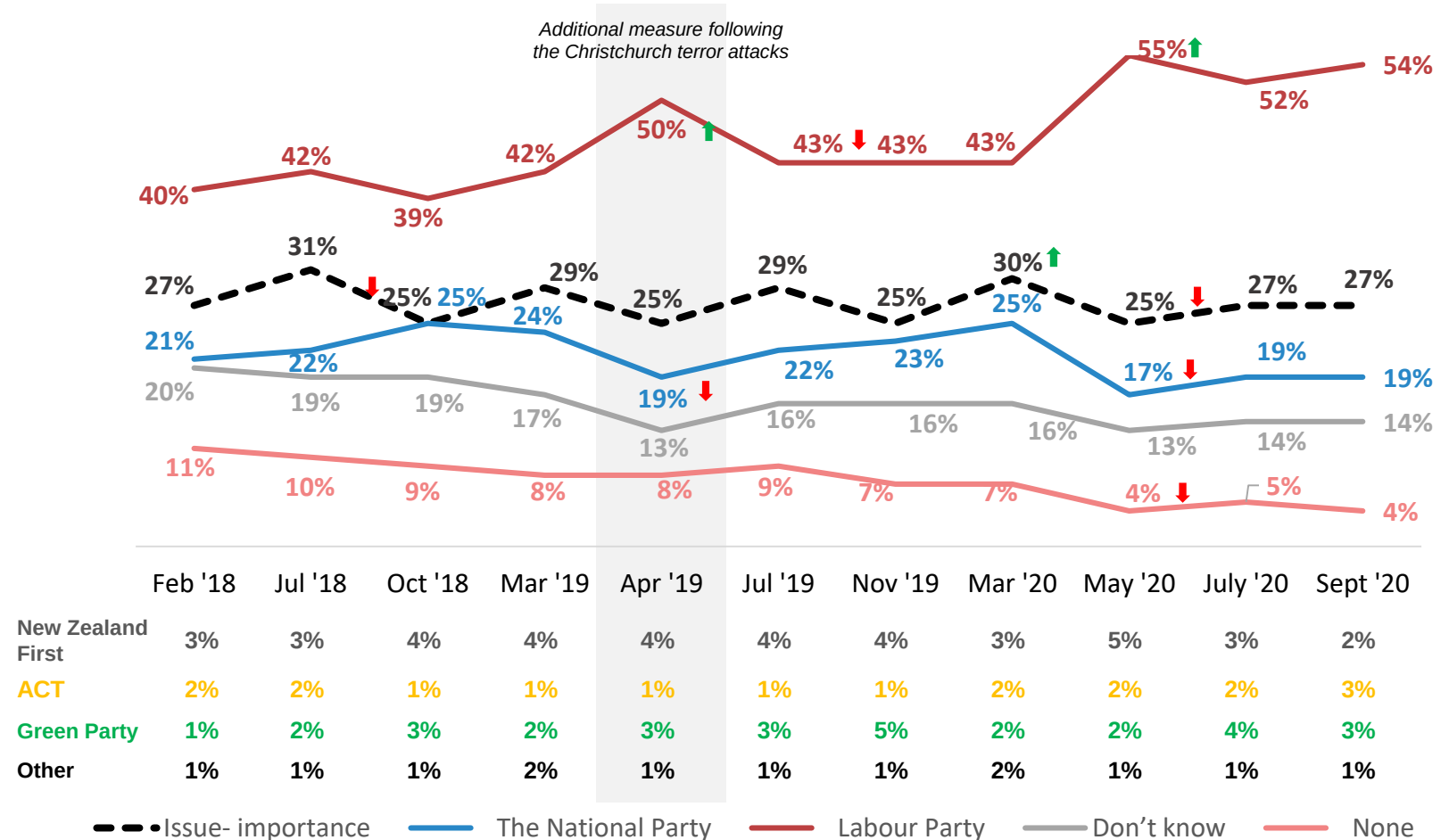
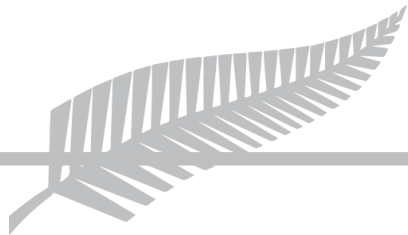
#3= ISSUE – HEALTHCARE / HOSPITALS

The Labour Party is still seen as the party most capable of managing healthcare issues.



Healthcare / hospitals has been a consistently highly rated issue since February 2018.

Labour has enjoyed a significant lead over other parties since we started tracking and the gap has further widened since the outbreak of the COVID-19 crisis.



Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Healthcare / Hospitals

Base: Approx. n=610 per wave, except for May '20, Jul '20, Sept '20 (n=1,000)

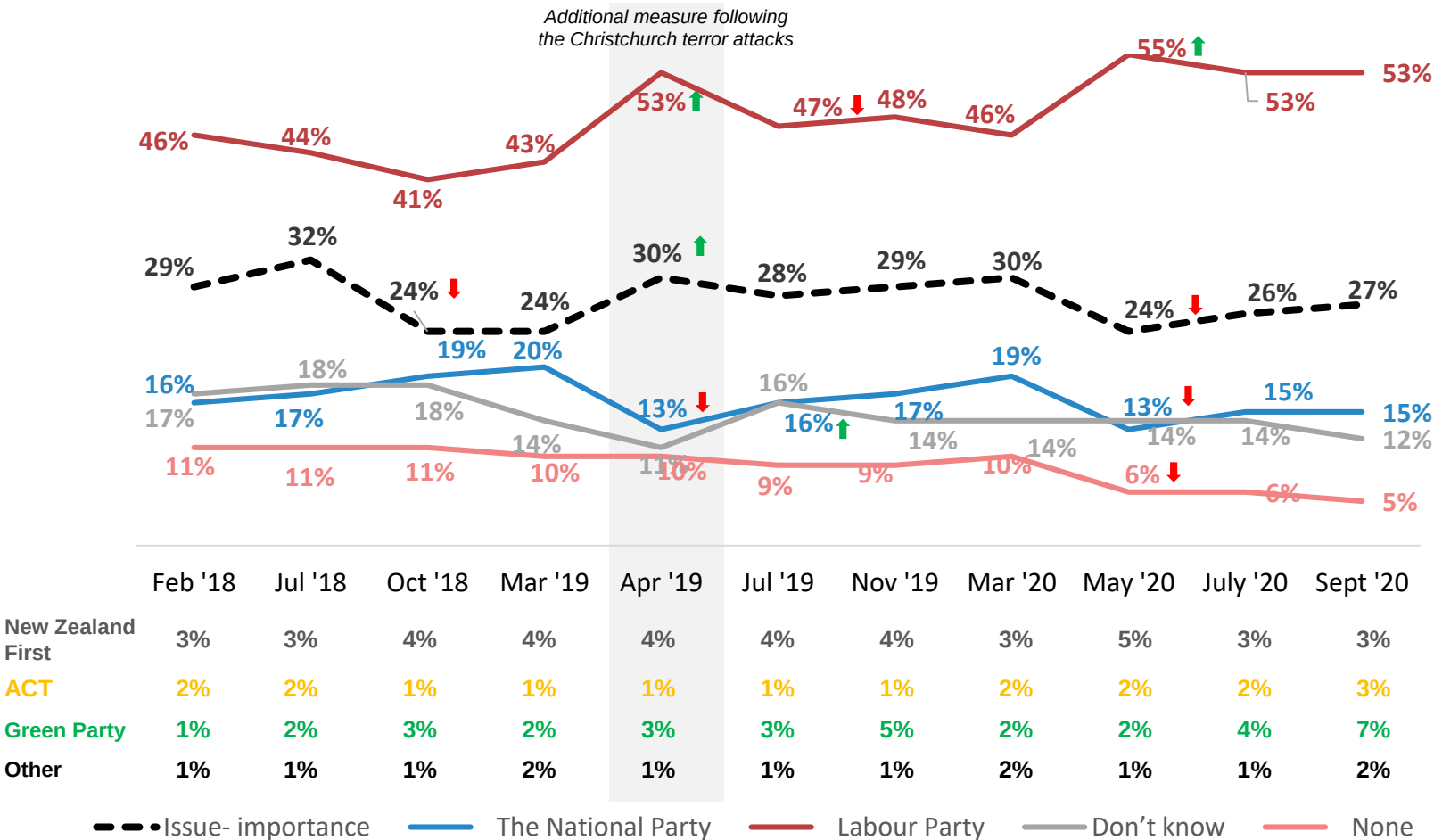
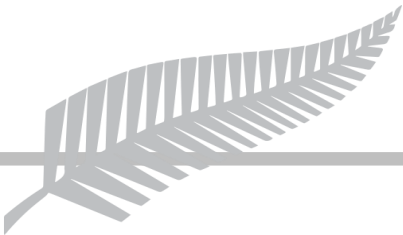
#3= ISSUE – POVERTY / INEQUALITY

The Labour Party is overwhelmingly seen as the most capable party to handle poverty & inequality issues.



Poverty / Inequality has been a consistently highly rated issue since February 2018.

Labour has enjoyed a significant lead over other parties since we started tracking and the gap has further widened since the outbreak of the COVID-19 crisis.



Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Poverty / Inequality
Base: Approx. n=610 per wave, except for May '20, Jul '20, Sept '20 (n=1,000)

COMPARING NZ'S ISSUES TO AUSTRALIA'S

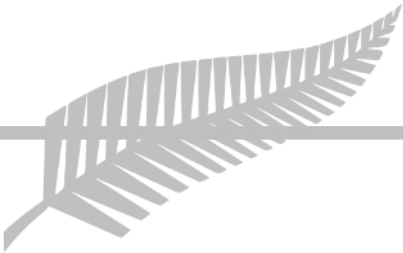
TOP 10 ISSUES - NZ VS. AUSTRALIA



The economy and unemployment dominate the top issues in Australia, just as they do in New Zealand.

Housing, a major issue in New Zealand (#2) isn't much of a concern in Australia (#7) comparatively.

Healthcare is one of the key issues across Australia and New Zealand both.

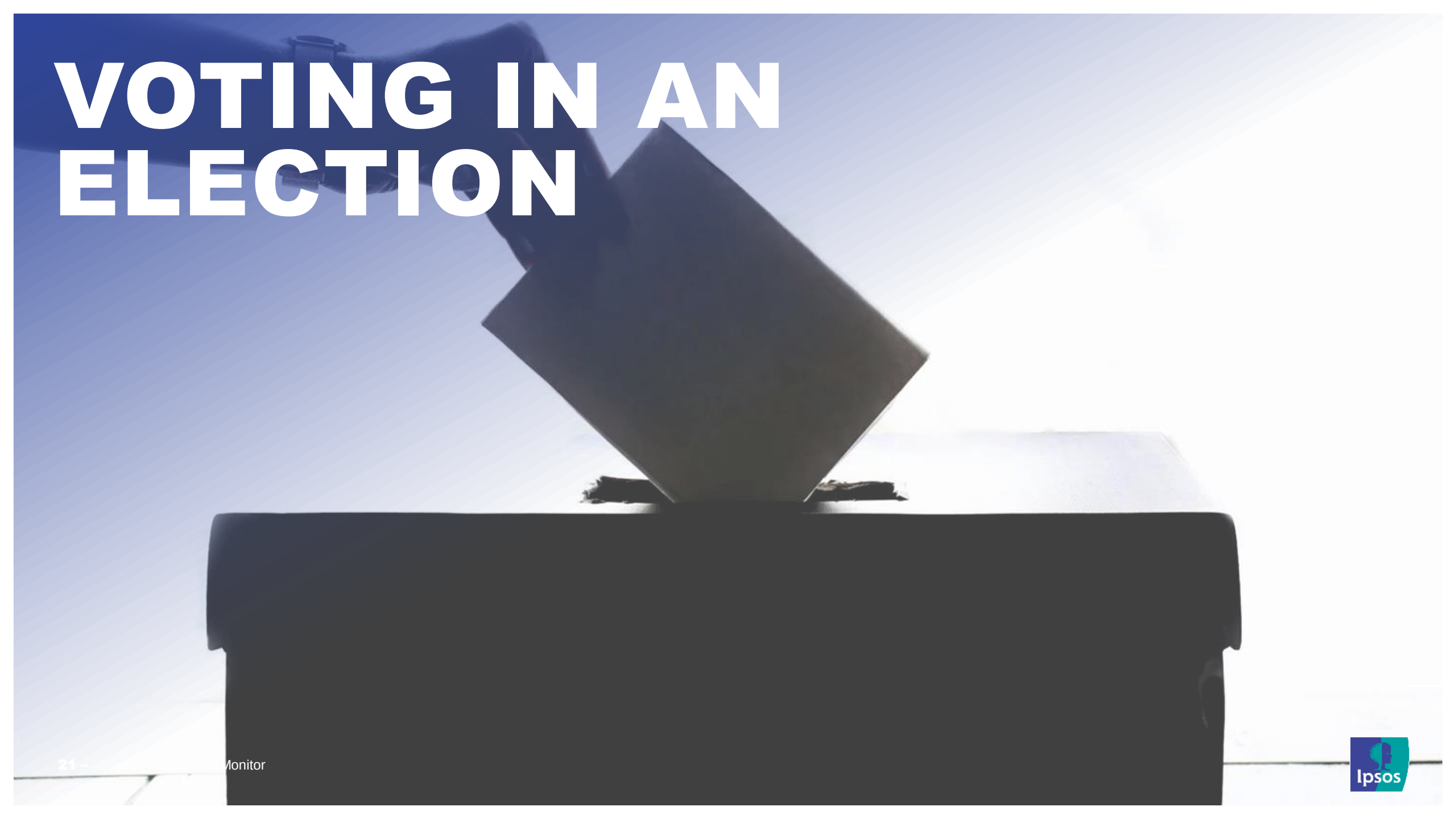


1	The Economy	42%
2	Housing / Price of Housing	37%
3 =	Unemployment	27%
3 =	Healthcare / Hospitals	27%
3 =	Poverty / Inequality	27%
6	Inflation / Cost of Living	22%
7	Climate Change	18%
8	Crime/ Law and Order	16%
9	Drug / Alcohol Abuse	14%
10	Environmental Pollution / Water Concerns	13%

1	The Economy	56%
2	Unemployment	44%
3	Healthcare / Hospitals	34%
4	Inflation / Cost of Living	24%
5	The Environment	20%
6	Crime / Law and Order	19%
7	Housing / Price of Housing	16%
8	Poverty / Inequality	14%
9	Education	10%
10 =	Household / Personal Debt	9%
10 =	Immigration	9%
10 =	Drug abuse	9%

Base: September 2020 – New Zealand (n=1,000), Australia (n=1,045)

VOTING IN AN ELECTION

A close-up photograph of a hand dropping a white ballot into a dark ballot box. The hand is wearing a watch and is positioned at the top left of the frame. The ballot box is dark and has a slot on top. The background is a bright, slightly blurred outdoor scene with a blue sky and some greenery.

COMFORT WITH VOTING IN AN ELECTION

Comfort levels with voting in an election continue to increase.
Those over 35 years of age have higher comfort levels compared to those under 35 years of age.



Q: How comfortable would you be voting in an election?
Base: Total (n=10,057), data collected on a weekly basis n=1000 per week, the dates mentioned above indicate the first and last date of FW within that level.
Historical data for this question has been taken from the COVID-19 tracker study run by Ipsos.
22 – © Ipsos | NZ Issues Monitor

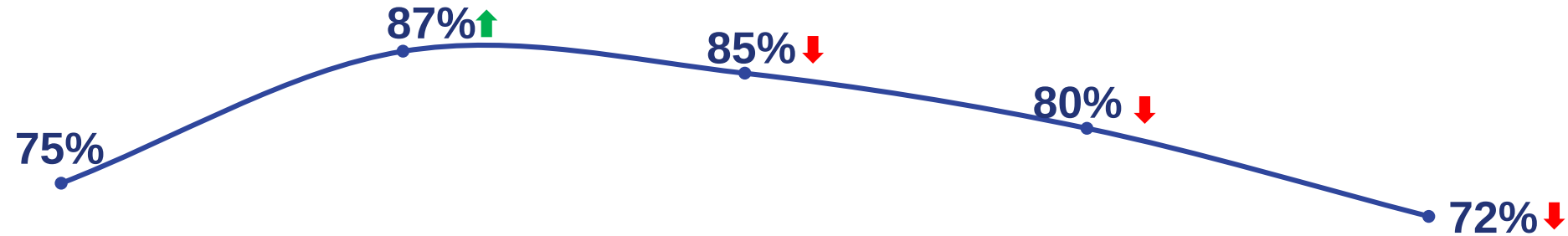
↑ ↓ Indicates significant increase / decrease in score compared to the previous level



KEEPING THE BORDER CLOSED

KEEPING THE BORDER CLOSED

The majority (72%) of New Zealanders believe that we should keep our borders closed. However, this has been declining since the level 4 lockdown.



Pre-lockdown

n= 2,000
March 12th – March 24th

Level 4

n= 5,057
March 28th – April 27th

Level 3

n= 1,000
May 1st – May 11th

Level 1

n= 1,000
July 3rd – July 6th

Level 2 / 2.5

n= 1,000
September 11th – 14th

Q: Do you agree or disagree with the following: We should close the borders of my country / keep the borders closed, and not allow anyone in or out until the virus is proven to be contained.

Base: Total (n=10,057), data collected on a weekly basis n=1000 per week, the dates mentioned above indicate the first and last date of FW within that level.

Historical data for this question has been taken from the COVID-19 tracker study run by Ipsos.

24 – © Ipsos | NZ Issues Monitor

↑ ↓ Indicates significant **increase** / **decrease** in score compared to the previous level

COVID VACCINE



This section was asked by Ipsos across 27 countries. Global fieldwork dates: July 24th – August 7th 2020

New Zealand scores have been added subsequently and are not included in the global average

The sample consists of approximately 1,000 individuals in each of Australia, Belgium, Brazil, Canada, China (mainland), France, Germany, Great Britain, Italy, Japan, Spain, and the U.S., and 500 individuals in each of Argentina, Chile, Hungary, India, Malaysia, Mexico, the Netherlands, Peru, Poland, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, South Korea, Sweden, and Turkey.

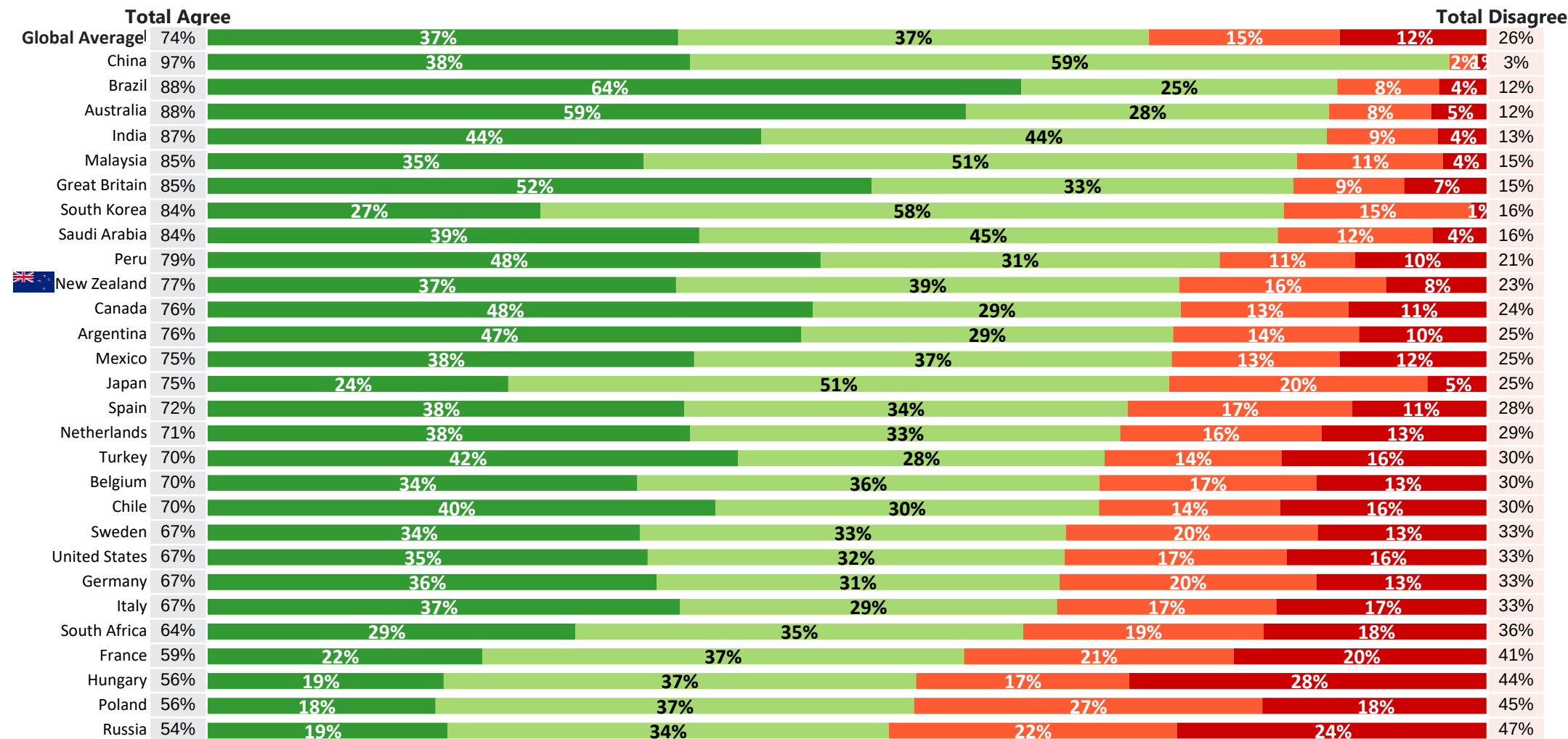
The samples in Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Canada, France, Germany, Great Britain, Hungary, Italy, Japan, the Netherlands, Poland, South Korea, Spain, Sweden, and the U.S. can be taken as representative of these countries' general adult population under the age of 75.

The samples in Brazil, Chile, China (mainland), India, Malaysia, Mexico, Peru, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and Turkey are more urban, more educated, and/or more affluent than the general population. The survey results for these countries should be viewed as reflecting the views of the more "connected" segment of these population.

The data is weighted so that each country's sample composition best reflects the demographic profile of the adult population according to the most recent census data.

GETTING A VACCINE, IF AVAILABLE

77% New Zealanders agree that they would get a COVID-19 vaccine should it become available compared to 88% Australians. Global average 74%.



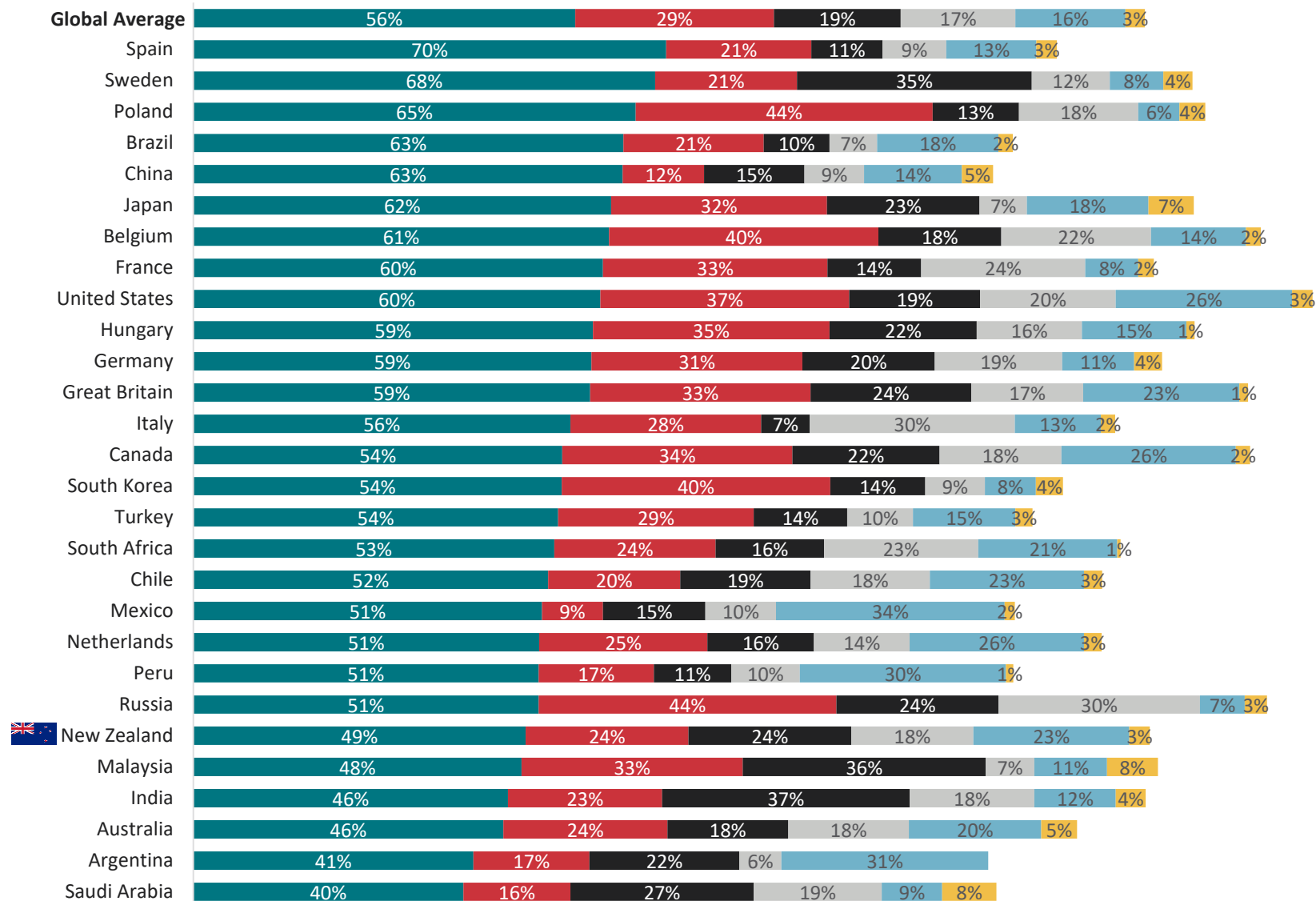
Q: To what extent do you agree or disagree with each of the following: If a vaccine for COVID-19 were available, I would get it
Base: NZ sample (n=1,000), Other countries combined sample (n=19,519)

Strongly agree Somewhat agree
Somewhat disagree Strongly disagree



REASON FOR NOT TAKING A VACCINE

Worry around the side effects is the main concern.



- I am worried about the side effects
- I don't think it will be effective
- I'm not enough at risk from COVID-19
- I am against vaccines in general
- Another reason
- I don't have the time

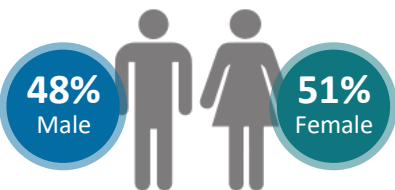
Q: Which best describes why you would not take a vaccine for COVID-19? (multi-response possible)

Base: NZ sample (n=234), Other countries combined sample (n=4,860)

SAMPLE DEMOGRAPHICS – SEPTEMBER '20



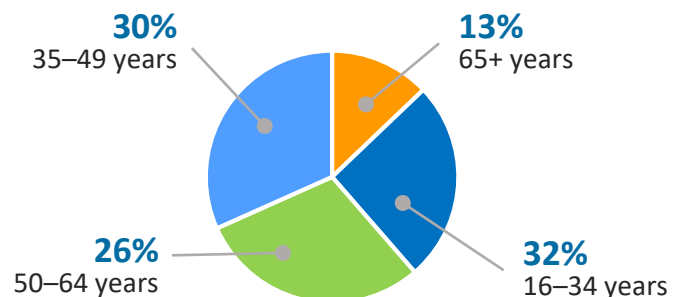
1,000 respondents
were interviewed online in May 2020 using the Dynata online panel



*1% answered 'gender diverse'

The precision of Ipsos online polls are calculated using a credibility interval with a poll of 1,000 accurate to +/- 3.5 percentage points

Results are weighted by age, gender and region to ensure they reflect the New Zealand Population



Employment status

43% Full-time
13% Part-time
11% Retired
10% Not in paid work but seeking work
9% Not in paid work & not seeking work
7% Self-employed
6% Student



Highest education completed*

38% Level 1-4
39% Level 5-7
17% Level 8-10
6% Don't know



Type of area live in

45% In the suburbs of a large city
18% In a rural area
14% In a large city
11% In, or right outside, a medium sized city
10% In, or right outside, a small city
1% None of these

SAMPLE SIZES OVER TIME: Sept '20 (n=1,000), July '20 (n=1,000), May '20 (n=1,000), Mar '20 (n=610), Nov '19 (n=610), Jul '19 (n=610), Apr '19 (n=615), Mar '19 (n=614), Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)

CONTACTS

Carin Hercock

Managing Director

✉ carin.hercock@ipsos.com

☎ +64 9 538 0537



Amanda Dudding

Research Director

✉ amanda.dudding@ipsos.com

☎ +64 21 61 22 64



ABOUT IPSOS

Ipsos is the third largest market research company in the world, present in 90 markets and employing more than 18,000 people.

Our research professionals, analysts and scientists have built unique multi-specialist capabilities that provide powerful insights into the actions, opinions and motivations of citizens, consumers, patients, customers or employees. Our 75 business solutions are based on primary data coming from our surveys, social media monitoring, and qualitative or observational techniques.

“Game Changers” – our tagline – summarises our ambition to help our 5,000 clients to navigate more easily our deeply changing world.

Founded in France in 1975, Ipsos is listed on the Euronext Paris since July 1st, 1999. The company is part of the SBF 120 and the Mid-60 index and is eligible for the Deferred Settlement Service (SRD).

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IPS:FP
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GAME CHANGERS

In our world of rapid change, the need for reliable information to make confident decisions has never been greater.

At Ipsos we believe our clients need more than a data supplier, they need a partner who can produce accurate and relevant information and turn it into actionable truth.

This is why our passionately curious experts not only provide the most precise measurement, but shape it to provide True Understanding of Society, Markets and People.

To do this we use the best of science, technology and know-how and apply the principles of security, simplicity, speed and substance to everything we do.

So that our clients can act faster, smarter and bolder.
Ultimately, success comes down to a simple truth:
You act better when you are sure.

**THANK
YOU**

GAME CHANGERS

